



Learn Advanced Excel: A 3-month Roadmap

3 Month **Advanced Excel** **Roadmap**

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Visit <https://chandoo.org/wp/> for more information.

[Join Excel School program](#) to learn all the topics in one place.

What & who is this roadmap for?

I have been using Microsoft Excel for almost 20 years. I have been teaching and consulting as an Excel specialist for last 15 of those years. Many times, my students, clients & friends ask me if there is a step-by-step roadmap to learn Excel for doing advanced data analysis & reporting work. This roadmap is my answer.

In this roadmap you will find all the necessary things to focus on for next 3 months. [Please do watch the companion video](#) before you start the journey. It will help you understand the context, learn a bit more about the specific items mentioned in this roadmap and take full advantage of the journey.



Who is this roadmap for?

This roadmap is for anyone interested in learning Advanced Excel Skills for Data Analysis and Reporting work. It is specifically designed for:

- People looking to learn “advanced Excel”.
- Who can allocate 4-8 hours every week for 12 weeks
- Understand basics of Excel & data.
- Are motivated and self-driven.

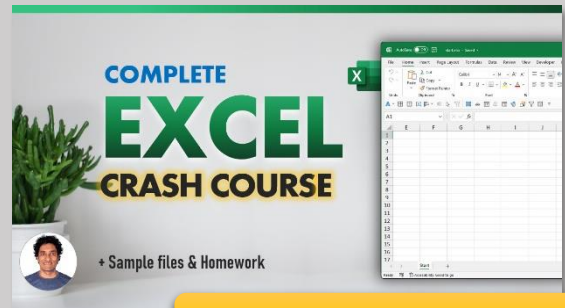
Month 1

Focus on getting & cleaning data

This month focuses on how to get, clean & manage data within Excel. The key learning objectives will be how to use Power Query, Tables, Data management features and how to perform simple "Exploratory Data Analysis" with Excel.

Technical Skills:

- [How to get in and use Excel?](#)
- [How to use Excel tables?](#)
- [How to use Power Query to load and clean data?](#)
- Working with [Flashfill](#), text to columns and other clean-up functions in Excel ([video](#))
- How to filter & sort data in Excel?
- Doing simple descriptive analysis of data within Excel
- How to use [Excel References](#) ([video](#))



Watch this video

Domain Skills:

In Month 1, learn about your industry / domain by:

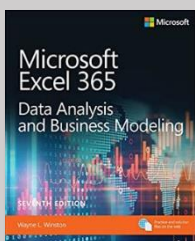
- Talking to your friends who work in the same domain
- Visiting company websites and understanding their business model and nature of work.
- Read books on Statistics and data analysis

Project:

In Month 1, You can do a simple project to implement all the skills you have learned.

1. **Build an Expense Tracker in Excel** that loads data from your bank statements (in PDF or CSV or Excel formats), cleans the data and tells you where your money is going.
2. **Run a survey about anything** on your friends and analyze the data. Use tools like Microsoft Forms or Google Forms to automate the data collection and Power Query to consolidate the data.
3. **Download any sports / movies or other favorite topic data** and cleanse & analyze it. See if you can find anything odd in the data. Use websites like [kaggle](#) to get the data.

Recommended Book:



I recommend reading the Data Analysis & Business Modeling book by Wayne Winston. You can finish a few chapters in month 1 and continue reading and re-reading in Months 2 & 3 (and after too!). [Get it from Amazon here](#).

Month 2

Focus on analyzing the data

This month, learn how to analyze the data by asking right questions, using formulas + pivot tables to answer them. Learn how to highlight important points and information with conditional formatting and how to make interactive analysis with slicers & data validation.

Technical Skills:

- **Formulas:**
 - [Top 10 Excel Formulas for Data Analysis](#)
 - [SUMIFS](#)
 - [XLOOKUP](#)
 - [FILTER](#)
 - [SUBTOTAL](#)
 - [IFERROR](#)
- **Pivot tables:**
 - [Introduction to Pivot tables \(video\)](#)
 - [Advanced Pivot Table tips & tricks](#)
 - [How to use Data Model & Relationship feature of Excel](#)
 - [Introduction to Power Pivot](#)
 - [More on Pivot Tables](#)
- **Concepts:**
 - [Average vs. Median vs. Quartiles](#)
 - [Data & BI Terminology](#)



Watch this video

Domain Skills:

In Month 2, learn about your industry / domain by:

- Studying necessary statistical and functional areas of your work.
- Talk to your friends in the industry. Take them out to coffee and ask them what they do, what kind of analysis they often do and how they do it.
- Find volunteer / freelance / extra work opportunities to practice what you are learning.
- Next time you meet your friends, discuss / analyze your favorite sports team / tv show / politics / weather / video game.
- Read books or watch videos about your domain.

Project

In Month 2, You can do a simple project to implement all the skills you have learned.

1. **Sales Report** from awesome chocolates dataset. [Use this dataset](#) and generate a sales report to show how an individual salesperson has done in 2021. Show their sales & boxes by product. Make it interactive so we can select another person easily. Build this with formulas alone and then with Pivot + formulas.
2. **Build a financial goal tracker.** You can input any number of goals and their cost (in today's terms) and the tracker tells you how much you should save to have the money in future (with inflation, various return rates).

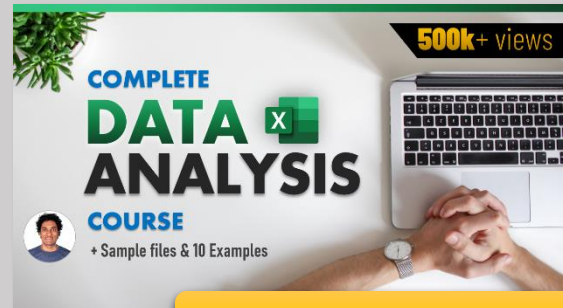
Month 3

Focus on presenting the data

This month build skills to present your data. Understand how various charts work, how to create and customize them, how to make them interactive and how to lay them out. Learn when to "not" use charts. Build verbal and written communication skills to share your insights with others.

Technical Skills:

- **Charting:**
 - [Select right chart type for your data](#)
 - [Rules for making column charts in Excel \(video\)](#)
 - [How to make a budget vs. actual chart in Excel](#)
 - [Create a basic interactive chart in Excel](#)
 - [How to use slicers in Excel?](#)
- **Dashboards**
 - [What is a dashboard and how to create one?](#)
 - [KPI Dashboard in Excel](#)
 - [Project Management Dashboard with Excel](#)
 - [200+ Dashboards – Examples, templates](#)
- **Concepts:**
 - [How to use Data Validation in Excel](#)
 - [Essential Excel Keyboard Shortcuts](#)
 - [How to use VBA](#)
 - [How to use Power BI](#)



Watch this video

Domain Skills

In Month 3, learn about your industry / domain by:

- Thinking about how the technical concepts relate to domain concepts you are learning.
- Imagine work scenarios and see what tech, domain skills are needed to solve them. (For ex, you want to know why shipments are delayed in the first quarter of the year, what domain knowledge is needed and what tech skills are needed to figure the reason?)
- Think about the human side of analysis. How people read & consume information etc.
- Learn more about your area of work and what will make you successful.

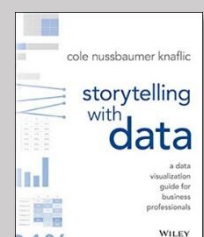
Project

In Month 3, here are a few projects you can try:

1. **Build a one-page dashboard for Awesome Chocolate CEO** with Excel [Use this dataset](#)
2. **Build a system to automate data collection**, clean-up, analysis, and visualization for your industry
3. **Make Expense Tracker 2.0** that can read a folder of monthly debit & credit files, show where the money is coming from and where it goes, spot trends and does forecasting.

Recommended Book:

I recommend reading *storytelling with data* by Cole N. Knaflitz. It gives you many ideas and practical examples of good data visualization. [Get it from Amazon here.](#)



All 3 months in one course



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★ ★ ★ ★ ★ by more than 10,000 students, this course will give you everything you need to be successful in workplace.

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